



SAFETY, REPORTING & PROTECTION

Sauti Salama

A GBV reporting and referral line for Kenya that works on any phone.
No internet. No app. Three key presses to reach a vetted neighbour.

THE PROBLEM

Violence at home is common. Reporting it is almost impossible.

40%+

of ever-partnered Kenyan women aged 15–49 have experienced physical or sexual violence from a partner

34%

of women have experienced physical violence since age 15; 13–14% sexual violence

72h

window for free HIV prevention after rape, which most survivors never hear about in time

The barriers are practical: the abuser controls the phone, there is no airtime or data, no private moment, and nobody to call who can come quickly.

WHAT EXISTS TODAY

Every channel assumes something the survivor does not have.

Helpline 1195

✗ You must speak out loud, with the abuser possibly in the next room.

GBV apps

✗ Need a smartphone, a data bundle and a phone nobody checks.

Police station

✗ Needs travel, money and a first contact that is often not survivor-centred.

About one in three Kenyan phones is still a **feature phone**. The tools were built for the other two.

THE IDEA

Any phone. No internet. No app. Three key presses to reach a vetted neighbour.

Call line

Speak

For low literacy and visual impairment. No menu: it listens and asks one question at a time, in her language.

USSD *384*7262#

Press

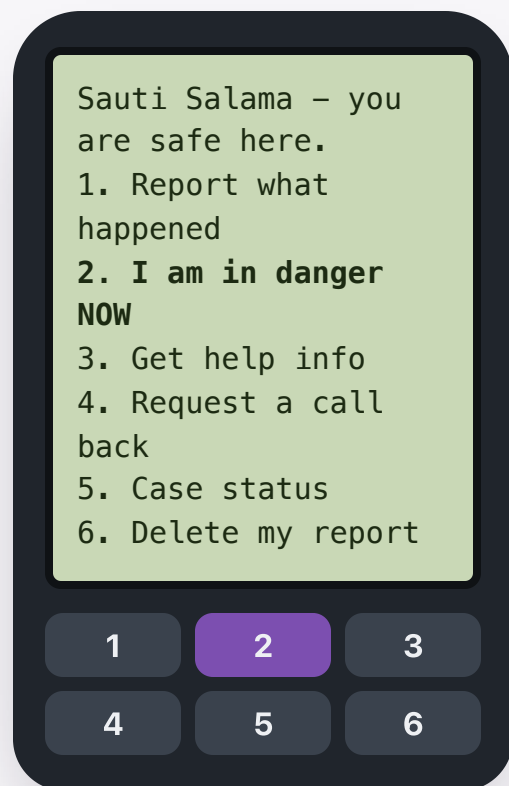
For anyone who cannot speak. Silent, free, no data, nothing left in the call log or inbox.

SMS 7262

Text

English, Kiswahili or Sheng. HELP for information, STOP to erase everything.

From "I am in danger" to a responder on the way.



SAUTI SALAMA ALERT [CRITICAL] SS-S6X6
Area: Dandora | ussd silent | en
Phone: DO NOT call or text
Reply ACK SS-S6X6 to accept.

Seconds

Vetted ward responder alerted by SMS

ACK by SMS

Console shows "Accepted in 2 min"

Survivor in control

Check status or erase, same free menu

THE CALL LINE

No menu. It answers, listens, and asks one question at a time.

1

She speaks, in her own words

English, Kiswahili or Sheng. Nothing to read, nothing to press, no options to remember

Speak

2

A responder is alerted from her first sentence

Not at the end of the call. She never has to finish talking before help is on its way

Seconds

3

Then only what changes what a responder does

Are you safe now, where are you, who did it, injuries, children. At most five questions, then consent is asked out loud

Consent

4

Saying nothing is treated as danger

A caller who cannot speak safely becomes a silent critical alert, not a question asked twice

Silence

A panicked Sheng text becomes a brief a responder can act on.

SMS RECEIVED

"Manze msee wangu amenichapa vibaya sana leo. Ako na kisu na anasema ataniua nikitoka. Niko Umoja, watoto wako hapa."

- **Groq** · open-weight gpt-oss-120b, strict JSON schema
- Brief in **English and Kiswahili**
- The AI **never** writes to a survivor

Critical urgency

Immediate danger

Violence	Physical
Person responsible	Intimate partner · with survivor now
Time since incident	About 6 hours
Risk flags	Weapon · Children present
Needs	Medical · Shelter · Legal · Counselling · Police (her choice)
Area	Umoja

Safety rules under the AI: keyword rules in English, Kiswahili and Sheng run first. The AI can raise urgency but never lower a danger signal, and the console shows every override.

CLEAR NEXT STEPS

Every case leaves with the right step and the deadline that matters.

1

Health facility for free post-rape care

HIV prevention (PEP) and the free PRC form (MOH 363); emergency contraception up to 120 hours

Within 72 h

2

Child protection

Childline Kenya 116, free 24 hours; a Children's Officer is involved (Children Act 2022)

Mandatory

3

Police Gender Desk and P3 form

Medical care never depends on reporting

Survivor's choice

4

Protection Order and free legal aid

Protection Against Domestic Violence Act 2015 · FIDA Kenya

Legal

5

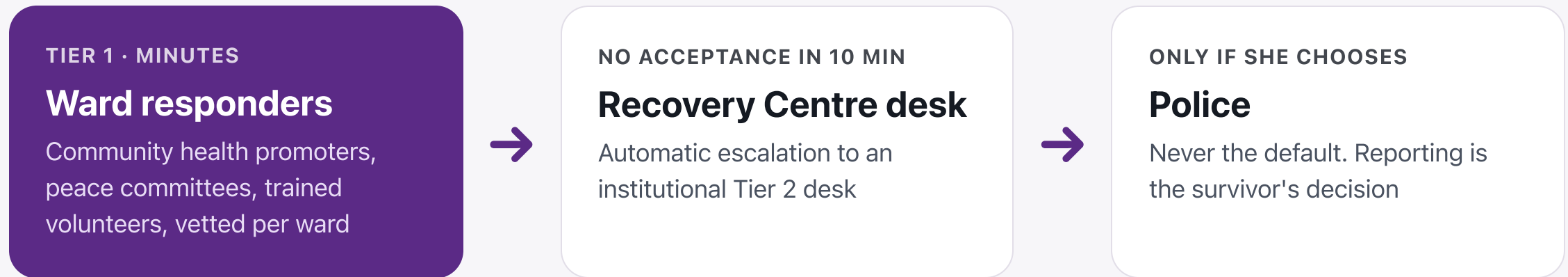
Shelter and counselling

Via 1195 and the GBV Recovery Centre; locations never published

24 h

SHIFTING POWER TO COMMUNITIES

The first responder is a vetted neighbour, not a distant institution.



Every case shows **time to accept**, so "timely support" is measured, not promised.

Built for the Kenya Data Protection Act 2019 from day one.

No registration, no ID

Anonymity is the difference between a report and no report.

Encrypted at rest

Phone numbers and statements use AES-256-GCM; the console shows masked numbers.

Consent before contact

A number is revealed only if the survivor said the phone is safe, and every reveal is logged.

Real erasure

Erase everything from a free USSD session; closed cases purge after 90 days. Deliberately no blockchain.

Abuse protection without ID checks: per-number rate limiting adds extra reports to the existing case, so a real emergency is never dropped.

WHY IT IS WORTH DEVELOPING

Cheap to run, nothing new in anyone's hands, and it creates the data counties lack.

1 SMS

is what a report costs her: no app, no bundle, no smartphone. Zero-rating the code is the first thing we negotiate.

0 MB

of data needed on the survivor's side. Works on every phone in Kenya.

Ward

level, anonymised patterns for county GBV working groups. Never a case.

A supervised pilot with the community that will run it.

Pilot

Two Nairobi responder networks and one GBV Recovery Centre as the escalation desk

Measure

Time to accept, time to reach her, and survivor-reported outcomes

Next

Live voice number, a real-time Kiswahili voice, three more languages, telco zero-rating

The code runs today on the cheapest phone in Kenya. What it needs next is a community to run it with. **Asante.**